CHRISTWOOD SCHOOL · TRANSPORT

Bus Tracking, Alerts & Student Boarding

Proposal for approval
25 August 2026
Phase 1 of 4 · Draft 1

Sixteen buses carry no tracking device, which we must put right under the school-bus tracking rules regardless. Approve that spend together with a four-phase, six-month build that turns it into live tracking for parents, a management dashboard and confirmed student boarding.

The addition costs little because three things already exist: student Google accounts parents already use, an attendant on every bus, and a school-owned fleet.

₹80,000	₹15,000	₹0	8 → 31
Devices required by law, 16 buses	All this project adds on top	Added running cost per year	Buses tracked

The four phases each useful alone

01 Approval and procurement
Quote the 16 devices, settle data access with Tata and Way4Track, confirm the obligation with the RTO consultant, name the operational owner.
Sept 2026 · 2–4 weeks

02 Live tracking and dashboard (a + d)
All 31 buses on one live map, three vendor feeds normalised into one. A campus geofence times every entry and exit; distance driven feeds the fuel report.
Oct–Nov 2026 · 6 weeks

03 Parent and management alerts (b)
Parents see their bus and hear when it leaves school, nears their stop and arrives. Times come from each route's own history. Parents can mark a child absent.
Nov 2026–Jan 2027 · 6 weeks

04 Student boarding (c)
The attendant confirms each child on and off against a photo grid. A child expected but not aboard alerts the office before the bus leaves. Empty-bus check at the end of every run.
Jan–Feb 2027 · 6 weeks

What it costs 31 buses

ITEM	ONCE	PER YEAR
REQUIRED BY LAW ANYWAY		
AIS 140 device + panic button × 16	80,000	–
SIM and platform for those 16	–	28,800
Activate 7 dormant Tata subscriptions	–	t.b.c.
Compliance	**80,000**	**28,800 +**
WHAT THIS PROJECT ADDS		
Mounts and chargers	15,000	–
Attendant devices (nil if own phones)	0	0
Cloud, maps, notifications, hosting	0	0
This project	**15,000**	**0**

Development in-house. Free tiers and licences already held avoid roughly ₹1.2L a year of SMS, ₹3–6L of attendance hardware and ₹1.5–5L a year of third-party platform fees.

The audit is done; the devices are capable. Eleven buses carry Tata's factory-fitted AIS 140 units (4 live, 7 needing a subscription), 4 run on Way4TrackPro, **16 have none**. The standard already requires every compliant unit to send to two destinations — so no new capability is needed, only Tata's agreement to point their second feed at us. If they decline, our own devices on those 11 cost **₹55,000** and end the dependency.

THIS COMMITS THE SCHOOL TO

An operational promise. Once parents can see the bus, a 7:15am failure means the office phone rings. Needs a named owner and a deputy.

A duty of care. Stating which child is aboard makes the school answerable, so boarding is attendant-confirmed and the daily rate is visible to management.

Children's data. The DPDP Act 2023 requires written parental consent and a stated retention period. Cheap now, expensive to retrofit.

Decisions needed to start

1. **Approve the compliance spend and the phase sequence.**
2. **Name the operational owner and deputy** for the 6:30am and 3:30pm windows.
3. **Approve consent and retention** — location held 90 days, boarding records one academic year.
4. **Confirm student accounts may carry parent notifications.** This is what keeps the running cost at zero.
5. **Agree a child not boarding alerts the office as well as the family.**

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